THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 8: **Understanding the World through Maps and Landforms** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A treaty to protect Antarctica makes sense because 1

(a) it is fragile and valuable for science **(b)** it has crops

(c) no one wants it **(d)** it has cities

2. A region of cold, treeless, frozen soil is 1

(a) desert only **(b)** savannah **(c)** steppe **(d)** tundra

3. Which is a correct inference about the Mercator map? 1

(a) Sizes near the poles are exaggerated **(b)** It shows height

(c) There is no distortion **(d)** Sizes near the equator are exaggerated

4. If the Amazon loses much forest, the global effect could be 1

(a) cooler Earth **(b)** no change

(c) more oxygen **(d)** more carbon dioxide and climate change

5. A flat grassland with few trees stretching across Eurasia is 1

(a) rainforest **(b)** steppe **(c)** tundra **(d)** oasis

6. Which landform is formed by plate collision? 1

(a) Fold mountains like the Himalaya **(b)** Atolls

(c) Sand dunes **(d)** Deltas

7. Which two features were created by the same plate collision? 1

(a) Alps and Sahara **(b)** Himalaya and Tibetan Plateau

(c) Andes and Gobi **(d)** Rockies and Nile

8. Which of these explains why Europe's plains have many big cities? 1

(a) Deserts **(b)** Fertile land and navigable rivers

(c) Volcanoes **(d)** Ice

9. **Assertion (A):** Coral reefs are called the 'rainforests of the sea'. 1

Reason (R): They shelter about a quarter of all ocean species.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true but R is false.

(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Suez Canal, opened in 1869, connects the Red Sea and the Mediterranean Sea. 1

Reason (R): The Gulf Stream is a warm ocean current that warms north-western Europe.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true but R is false.

(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What is the link between oceans and the water cycle? 2

12. Why would melting permafrost accelerate climate change? 2

13. Why are rainforest soils often poor despite lush forest? 2

14. Why is Antarctica protected by treaty? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Case: Dumping of used clothes in the Atacama. Suggest three solutions. 3

16. Evaluate why the Amazon is described as the 'Lungs of the Earth'. 3

17. Explain why rivers like the Nile support civilisations. 3

OR

Interpret: 'Wolves restored Yellowstone.' Explain the chain. 3

18. Case: A cartographer needs to show shipping routes. Choose and justify a projection. 3

OR

Evaluate threats to the Great Lakes and their solutions. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Sailors use maps drawn on the Mercator projection because it preserves shape and direction. However, on such a map Greenland looks as large as Africa although Africa is about fourteen times larger. The Earth itself is an oblate spheroid, slightly flattened at the poles. 5

(i) For which users is the Mercator projection helpful?

(ii) What does 'oblate spheroid' mean?

(iii) Why does Greenland look so large on this map?

(iv) Why is the Mercator map unsuitable for comparing sizes of countries?

20. Case study: Yellowstone's elk and wolves. Draw lessons for managing other ecosystems. 5

OR

Discuss how a changing climate may alter oceans, ice and landforms. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks